

Chapter 5: Religious Trends in Ancient India

Textbook Exercise Solutions & Answers



1. Fill in the blanks:

Q1.) The principle of _____ is very important in Jainism.

(c) non-violence

Q2.) An extraordinary feature of Gautam Buddha's personality is his _____ for all living beings.

(a) compassion

2. Answer in short:

Q1.) What were the teachings of Vardhaman Mahavir?

Vardhaman Mahavir taught that the greatness of a human being does not depend on their varna or birth, but on their moral character, pure conduct, and compassion towards all living beings.

Q2.) Which famous quotes of Gautam Buddha have you read here? What value does it uphold?

1. One famous quote of Gautam Buddha is: *"Even the little quail can chirp freely in her nest."*
2. This quote upholds the values of freedom, independence, and the inherent equality of all living beings. Gautam Buddha also emphasized that women, just like men, have equal rights to their spiritual upliftment and salvation.

Q3.) What virtues are emphasized in Judaism?

Judaism emphasizes justice, truth, peace, love, compassion, humility, charity, ethical speech, and mutual respect.

Q4.) What are the teachings of Christianity?

1. According to Christianity, all human beings are brothers and sisters, children of one loving God.
2. It teaches universal love towards everyone, including one's enemies.
3. It emphasizes showing mercy and forgiving those who err or do wrong.

Q5.) What are the teachings of Islam?

1. Islam teaches that Allah is eternal, absolute, all-powerful, and merciful.
2. The purpose of human life is to worship Allah and live in righteousness.
3. The Holy Quran Sharif provides ethical guidance on leading an honest, compassionate, and disciplined life.

Q6.) What is at the core of Parsee thinking?

At the core of Parsee (Zoroastrian) philosophy are three cardinal principles of conduct: **Good Thoughts** (Humata), **Good Words** (Hukhta), and **Good Deeds** (Hvarshta).

3. Write notes on:

Q1.) Aryasatya

Aryasatyas are the Four Noble Truths that lie at the root of all human existence, expounded by Gautam Buddha:

- 1. **Dukkha (Suffering):** There is suffering in human life.
- 2. **The Cause of Suffering (Samudaya):** There is a cause behind all suffering (desire / attachment).
- 3. **Dukkha-Nivaran (Cessation of Suffering):** It is possible to end suffering.
- 4. **Pratipad (The Path):** There is an eightfold path (Ashtangika Marga) that leads to the complete end of suffering.

Q2.) Panchasheel

Gautam Buddha prescribed five moral precepts called *Panchasheel* for ethical living:

- 1. Abstain from killing or harming living beings.
- 2. Abstain from stealing or taking what is not given.
- 3. Abstain from unethical or unlawful sexual conduct.
- 4. Abstain from telling lies or deceitful speech.
- 5. Abstain from consuming intoxicating drinks and drugs.

4. Put the following in the proper place in the chart of the Five Great Vows and the Three Jewels:

Five Great Vows (Pancha Mahavratas)	Three Jewels (Triratnas)
1. Ahimsa (Non-violence) 2. Satya (Truth) 3. Asteya (Non-stealing) 4. Aparigraha (Non-attachment) 5. Brahmacharya (Chastity)	1. Samyak Darshan (Right Faith / Perception) 2. Samyak Jnan (Right Knowledge) 3. Samyak Charitra (Right Conduct)

5. Give reasons:

Q1.) Why was the name 'Jina' given to Vardhaman Mahavir?

Vardhaman Mahavir was given the title *Jina* (the Conqueror) because he conquered his physical senses and passions. Neither worldly pleasures brought him joy, nor did pain and adverse circumstances cause him sorrow or agitation.

Q2.) Why did Gautam Buddha come to be called the Buddha?

Gautam Buddha attained supreme enlightenment and realized the true nature of human life and existence in its entirety. The word *Buddha* means 'the Awakened' or 'the Enlightened One'.